are examples of precipitation.

pressure
The amount of force that is applied to a surface per unit of area.

protein
A type of complex chemical found in all living things, used as enzymes and in muscles. A protein is a chain of simple units called amino acids. There are about 20 natural amino acids, and a protein has hundreds of these units connected in a specific order.

protist
A single-celled organism with a complex cell structure, including organelles and a nucleus.

proton
A positively charged particle that is located in the nuclei of all atoms.

pupate
To prepare to change from a larva to an adult form (imago); for example, a caterpillar pupates as a chrysalis before emerging as a butterfly.

radiation
Waves of energy that travel through space. Radiation includes visible light, heat, X-rays, and radio waves; nuclear radiation includes subatomic particles and fragments of atoms.

radicals
Atoms, molecules, or ions with unpaired electrons that cause them to react easily.

radioactive
Relating to atoms that are unstable and break apart, releasing high-energy particles.

rarefaction
A decrease in the pressure and density of molecules along a longitudinal wave.

reactivity
A description of how likely a substance is to become involved in a chemical reaction.

reduction
When a substance gains electrons during a chemical reaction and so its oxidation number is reduced.

reflection
When a wave bounces off a surface.

refraction
When a wave changes direction as it passes from one medium to another.

repulsion
A force that pushes things apart; the opposite of attraction.

respiration
The process occuring in all living cells that releases energy from glucose to power life.

rubisco
Short for "ribulose bisphosphate carboxylase oxidase," an enzyme that is responsible for taking carbon dioxide from the atmosphere and reacting it with water to make glucose as part of photosynthesis.

salt
An ionic compound formed by a reaction between an acid and base (including an alkali).

sedimentary rock
A rock that forms from sediments, which are layers of substances that have settled on the seabed or ground before becoming buried and compressed for millions of years.

solute
A substance that becomes dissolved in another.

solvent
A substance that can have other substances dissolved in it.

speed
The rate of how fast an object is moving.

states of matter
The three main forms of matter that a substance can take are: solid, liquid, or gas. Plasma is a fourth state of matter.

strain
The change of the shape of an object in response to stress.

stress
A force that alters the shape of an object, by stretching, bending, and sometimes breaking it.

subatomic particle
A particle that is smaller than an atom, such as a proton, neutron, and electron.

superconductor
A material that conducts electricity without warming up and so wastes none of the energy it is carrying.

suspension
A mixture in which small solids, blobs of liquid, or gas bubbles are spread throughout a liquid.

temperature
An average measure of the thermal energy or heat of an object.

torque
The turning effect of a force.

torsion
A twist caused by torque.

transformer
A device for altering the voltage of an electrical current.

transverse
A wave that moves by rising and falling perpendicular to the direction of its motion.

vapor
Another word for a gas.

vascular
Concerning vessels, tubes that transport substances around a body.

velocity
A speed of something in a particular direction.

vertebrate
An animal that has a vertebral column, a flexible spine made from a chain of smaller bones called vertebrae; the largest animals are vertebrates, and include fish, amphibians, reptiles, mammals, and birds.

vesicle
A membranous sac that contains a material being processed by a cell; a vesicle may be used to release substances from a cell.

voltage
A measure of the force that pushes electrons around an electric current.

xylem
The vascular tissue that transports water and minerals around a plant.

wavelength
The distance measured between any point on a wave and the equivalent point on the next wave.

weight
The force applied to a mass by gravity.

work
The amount of energy transferred when a force is being applied to a mass over a certain distance.